

Why do volcanoes erupt?

Volcanoes can erupt when pressure deep underground forces hot, liquid rock (called magma) from inside the Earth up to the surface. An eruption blasts out clouds of ash and molten (melted) rock into the air around it.

Escape route

Magma rises up a main pipe from deep within the Earth's crust and is forced toward the surface.

Trapped underground

Pools of magma build up deep underground. This hot, liquid rock comes from the Earth's interior.

Quick quiz



Where does magma come from?



Why are volcanoes often cone-shaped?



How many volcanoes erupt each year?

